

Phased roadmap

Tied to funding tranches and to the two questions that decide the business: what does an utterance cost, and does it work in a loud shop in someone else's voice.

The sequencing rule. Every phase must close a gap in the evidence register before it adds a feature. A prototype that grows features without closing gaps becomes harder to fund, not easier.

0–6 months · pre-seed · ₹60 lakh from the model

Track	What ships	Why it is first
Android app	Native rewrite. On-device wake word in a foreground service. Bluetooth Classic printing. Local SQLite store — offline billing .	Offline is a disqualification against Vyapar, not a feature gap. And the browser cannot reach the printers this market buys.
Measure the unknowns	Instrument billing duration, utterances per bill, correction rate, error rate. Get the real Sarvam invoice.	Four of the five sensitivities are measurable today and none are measured. This is the cheapest work with the highest effect on the raise.
On-device ASR spike	Quantised streaming model on code-mixed Tamil retail speech. Target: beat the ₹0.06/utterance break-even.	Go / no-go on the whole cost structure. Better to learn in month 3 than month 12.
Natural-language analytics	"How much coffee did I sell last week", asked aloud, answered aloud.	Ragas's owner does not know his own margins. This is the clearest unmet need we have observed first-hand.
10 design partners	Chennai, mixed formats, at least half kirana rather than café.	Retention is the weakest number in the model. Only real shops fix that.
Team	Founder + 1 ASR/Android engineer	Founder unpaid. That is the capital-efficiency story, stated plainly.

Gate to the next tranche: on-device ASR under the break-even rate · offline billing working · 10 shops retained 8+ weeks · measured error rate and billing time.

6–18 months · seed

Track	What ships	Build or buy
Tier 2 product	Multi-counter sync, order management, CRM depth via RAGaaS, loyalty.	Integrate RAGaaS rather than build CRM. The only reason a small team can show this at all.
Inventory	Deduction on sale, low-stock alerts. Forecasting comes later and is statistical, not generative.	Build — it is the same data model.
Compliance	Full tax invoice: per-SKU HSN and rate, registration scheme.	Build. Needed the moment a shop crosses the threshold.
Channel	Printer dealers and local IT shops. One curated kit, one SKU, one set of support questions.	Partner. Founder-led acquisition does not reach 600 shops.
Payments	Stay on UPI rails. We never touch funds.	Never build. Different licence, different business.
Team	+1 engineer, +1 field/onboarding lead	Founder starts taking salary.

Gate: ~600 Tier 1 shops · Tier 2 in ≥ 25 · CAC payback under 3 months on the reseller channel · churn measured, not assumed.

18–36 months · Series A or profitable growth

Track	What ships	Note
Tier 3	Multi-store HQ, predictive replenishment (Croston/ETS), anomaly detection.	The first tier where a learned model earns its place — there is finally enough data.
Language 7+	Marathi, Bengali, Gujarati. Config, not code.	The pack architecture already assumes this.
Ecosystem	ONDC, WhatsApp ordering, aggregators.	Evaluate as distribution, not just integration.
Corpus	Opt-in corrected-utterance corpus at scale → materially better on-device model.	The moat compounding. Never conflate consented data with production data.
Team	~8–10	Support must stay near-zero-touch or Tier 1 economics break.

What we will not do

- **Manufacture hardware.** Different economics, different capital, different investor.
- **Hold payment funds.** Licensing and float risk we have no reason to take.
- **Chase F&B depth.** Petpooja has a decade of it. We win at the counter that still uses paper.
- **Sell shop data before the shop benefits.** A brand paying for shelf intelligence is not paying to help the shopkeeper negotiate. Opt-in, late, or not at all.